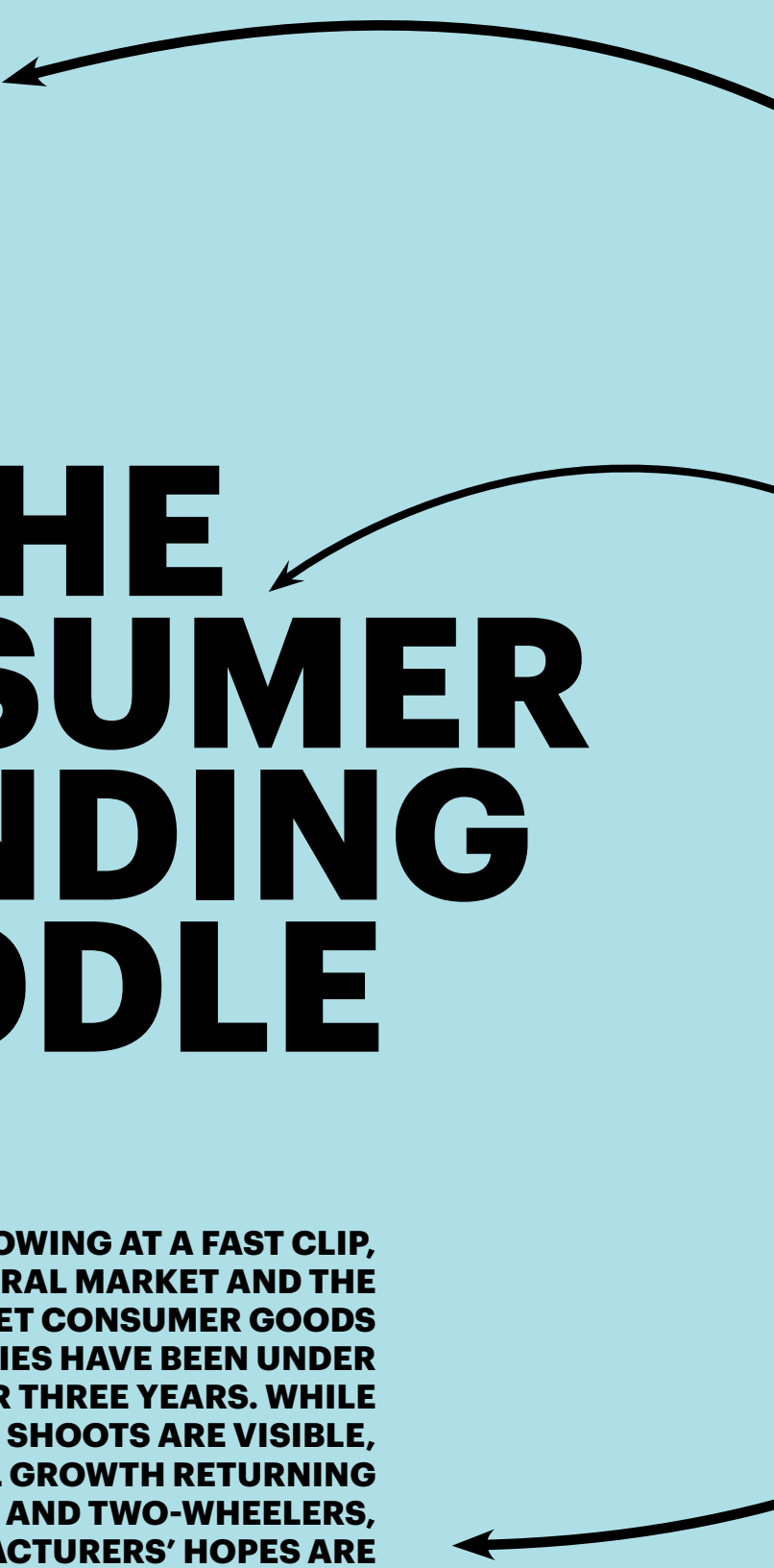


| COVER STORY **CONSUMPTION** |



THE CONSUMER SPENDING RIDDLE

**ONCE GROWING AT A FAST CLIP,
THE RURAL MARKET AND THE
MASS-MARKET CONSUMER GOODS
CATEGORIES HAVE BEEN UNDER
STRESS FOR THREE YEARS. WHILE
GREEN SHOOTS ARE VISIBLE,
WITH RURAL GROWTH RETURNING
FOR FMCG AND TWO-WHEELERS,
MANUFACTURERS' HOPES ARE
RIDING ON A GOOD MONSOON AND
GOVERNMENT SPENDING**